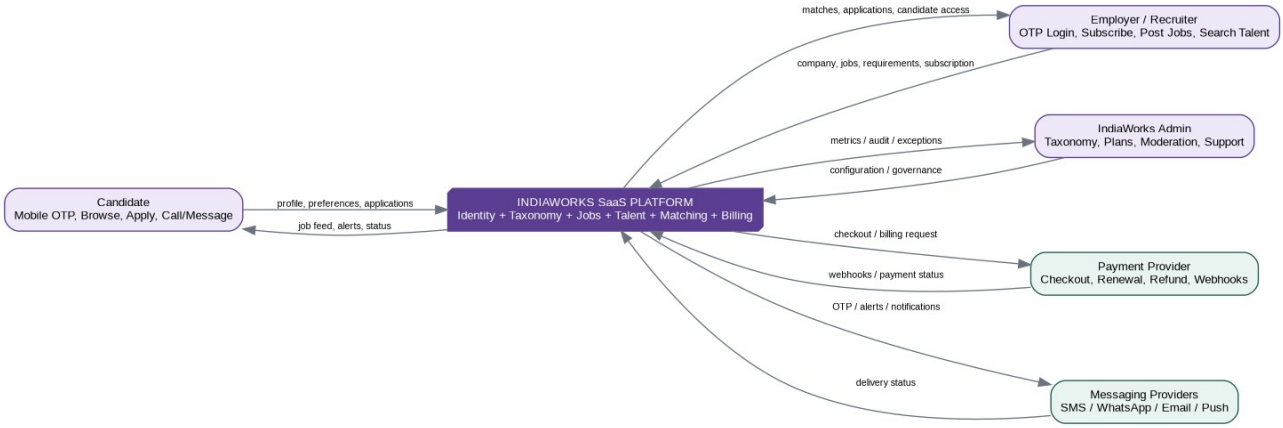
IndiaWorks Unified SaaS - Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Employer Subscription + Job Promotion + Candidate Marketplace

IndiaWorks | Unified SaaS Architecture v7
Generated 25 September 2026
Baseline: v5 Unified SaaS + v6 Product/Technical Review + v7 Five-Candidate Commercial Gate

1. Executive Summary

IndiaWorks is a two-sided hiring SaaS marketplace for India. Candidates use a low-friction mobile OTP flow to discover and apply to relevant jobs. Employers create verified organisations, subscribe on a trial/monthly/yearly basis, publish structured jobs, search relevant candidate profiles, reveal permitted candidate contact details, and optionally promote job visibility. The commercial model is organisation-centric and entitlement-based; it does not sell unrestricted raw candidate database exports.



Business context / DFD Level 0

2. Source Baseline and Design Continuity

Source artifact	What is retained
Employer/Auth/Job Posting Taxonomy GraphQL Architecture v3	Multi-tenant organisation model, structured taxonomy, job requirements, candidate search, contact policy, privacy/audit boundary.
Candidate Onboarding & Application Architecture v4	Mobile OTP, progressive profile, jobs feed/search, soft-vs-hard application gating, application snapshot/event model, direct employer contact policy, alerts and candidate discoverability.

3. Business Vision

- Enable enterprises, startups, MSMEs and businesses to hire frontline, skilled, service, gig and professional talent using structured requirements rather than unstructured CV search.
- Enable candidates to reach jobs with minimal onboarding friction and to control whether their profile is discoverable beyond jobs they applied to.
- Monetise employer access through trial, monthly and yearly subscriptions plus controlled job-promotion/add-on products.
- Create a reusable India-specific occupation, skills, credentials, geography and engagement taxonomy that powers both job posting and candidate matching.
- Provide measurable hiring outcomes: search-to-contact, application-to-shortlist, time-to-fill, hires, and promoted-job lift.

4. Actors and Stakeholders

Actor	Primary goals	Commercial / access relationship
Candidate	Find nearby/relevant work, apply quickly, contact employer where allowed, receive alerts.	Free user; no subscription required.
Employer Owner/Admin	Create organisation, subscribe, manage recruiters, jobs, billing and usage.	Pays for organisation plan/add-ons.
Recruiter	Post jobs, search candidates, shortlist, reveal contact, manage applications.	Consumes organisation entitlements.
Billing Admin	Manage plan, invoices, payment method and renewals.	Organisation role.
IndiaWorks Admin	Manage plans, taxonomy, moderation, support, audit and analytics.	Platform operator.
Payment Provider	Collect subscription/add-on payments and emit payment/renewal/refund events.	External integration.
Messaging Provider	OTP, alerts and transactional notifications.	External integration.

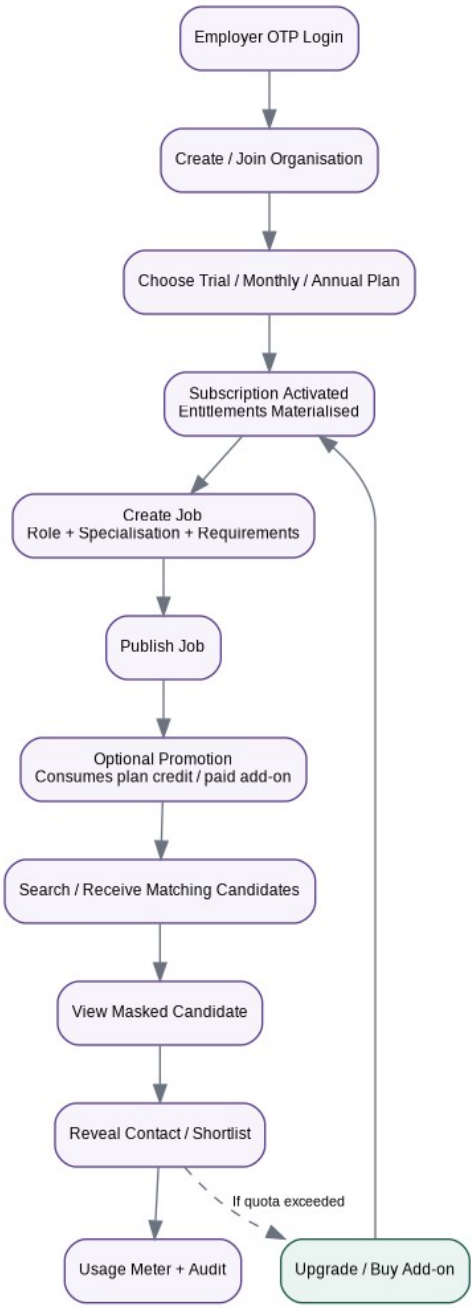
5. Business Model

Pricing amounts are intentionally configuration, not schema. The platform supports three core billing modes and optional add-ons:

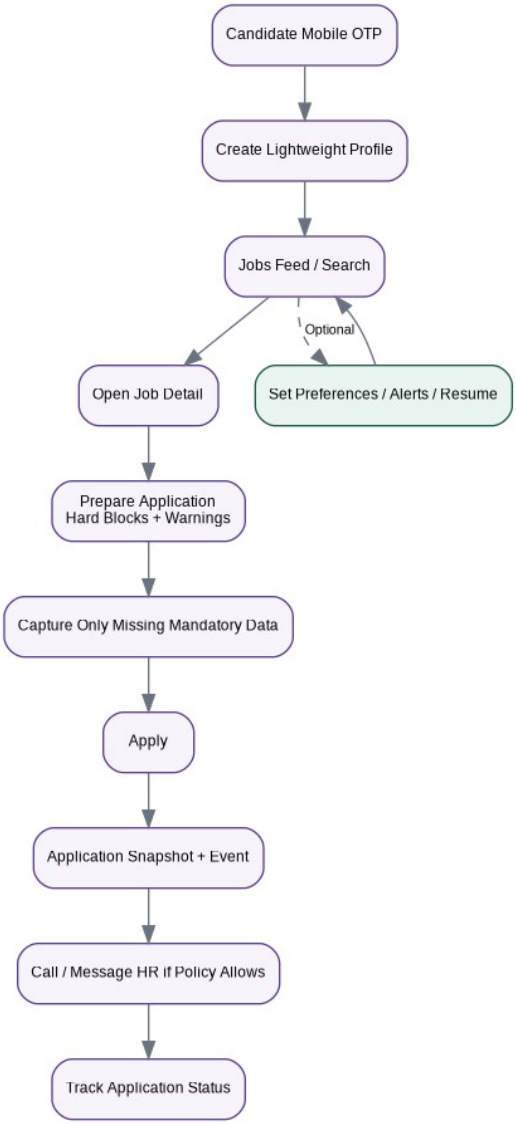
Offering	Billing behavior	Typical entitlement pattern
Trial	Free evaluation/trial entry point. Candidate access is hard-gated after five lifetime distinct candidate unlocks unless the organisation upgrades.	5 distinct candidate unlocks (reset NONE), masked browsing, limited active jobs/seats/promotion as configured.
Monthly	Recurring monthly subscription.	Monthly-reset usage limits and/or included credits.
Annual	Recurring yearly subscription, usually discounted commercially.	Annual commitment; usage can reset monthly or annually by entitlement definition.
Add-on	One-time or recurring purchase.	Extra contact reveals, promotion credits, recruiter seats, API/export package.

6. End-to-End Business Flows

6.1 Employer commercial flow



6.2 Candidate flow



7. Business Requirements

ID	Area	Requirement	Priority
BR-001	Candidate access	Candidates shall authenticate using mobile OTP and reach the jobs feed without mandatory full-profile completion.	MUST
BR-002	Employer access	Employers shall authenticate using verified mobile or email OTP and operate within an organisation tenant.	MUST
BR-003	Organisation tenancy	Subscriptions, usage,	MUST

ID	Area	Requirement	Priority
		jobs and recruiter permissions shall belong to an organisation, not an individual recruiter.	
BR-004	Plan catalogue	IndiaWorks shall support configurable Trial, Monthly and Annual plans.	MUST
BR-005	Entitlements	Each plan shall define feature access and limits including active jobs, candidate searches, CANDIDATE_UNLOCK, contact reveals, recruiter seats and promotion credits.	MUST
BR-006	Billing lifecycle	The platform shall handle trial, active, past-due, cancelled, expired and suspended subscription states.	MUST
BR-007	Structured jobs	Employers shall post jobs using canonical Role/Specialisation/Work Context plus independent engagement, work mode, geography, compensation and requirements.	MUST
BR-008	Candidate discovery	Subscribed employers shall search only candidates permitted by candidate discoverability/consent and plan entitlements.	MUST
BR-009	Masked results	Candidate search results shall mask contact PII until a permitted reveal/contact action.	MUST
BR-010	Contact metering	Contact reveal/contact initiation shall be auditable and consume entitlements exactly once using idempotency.	MUST

ID	Area	Requirement	Priority
BR-011	Job promotion	Employers shall promote eligible published jobs using plan credits or paid add-ons.	SHOULD
BR-012	Promotion fairness	Promotion shall boost only jobs that already pass eligibility and relevance rules; it shall not bypass hard requirements.	MUST
BR-013	Application	Candidates shall apply with minimum friction; soft preference mismatches warn but do not block.	MUST
BR-014	Hard eligibility	Only explicit legal, safety or genuinely mandatory credential requirements should block application.	MUST
BR-015	Application history	The system shall preserve application status history and apply-time snapshots.	MUST
BR-016	Direct contact	Candidate call/message actions shall obey each job contact policy and window.	SHOULD
BR-017	Candidate alerts	Candidates may opt into job alerts independently from authentication consent.	SHOULD
BR-018	Taxonomy governance	Taxonomy and external mappings shall be versioned and administratively governed.	MUST
BR-019	Usage transparency	Employer admins shall see plan limits, current usage, renewal/trial date and upgrade options.	MUST
BR-020	Auditability	Candidate access, reveals, exports, plan changes, payment status changes and administrative overrides shall be	MUST

ID	Area	Requirement	Priority
		auditable.	
BR-021	Privacy	Candidate talent-pool discoverability shall be a separate purpose/consent from applying to one job.	MUST
BR-022	Notifications	OTP, billing, job/application and alert communications shall respect channel preferences and purpose.	MUST
BR-023	Admin operations	Admins shall configure plans, entitlements, promotion products, taxonomy and moderation controls without code changes where practical.	SHOULD
BR-024	Analytics	The platform shall measure funnel metrics without exposing unnecessary candidate PII.	SHOULD
BR-025	Extensibility	The commercial layer shall not require separate schemas for blue/white/grey/service/gig workers.	MUST

8. Core Business Rules

- A candidate is free to browse/apply; employers fund the marketplace.
- A plan is a versioned commercial product. Entitlements are features/limits attached to a plan version.
- Publishing a job requires a valid organisation membership and an entitlement permitting an additional active job.
- Candidate search and contact reveal are separate entitlements. Search does not automatically grant contact access.
- One contact reveal should be idempotently metered per configured policy (for example per candidate per organisation, or per candidate/job pair). This policy is configuration and must be explicit.
- Job promotion has a defined start/end window and boost weight. Promotion is never a substitute for candidate/job eligibility.
- Applications remain valid historical records even if the employer subscription later lapses; employer access to new candidate discovery may be restricted.
- Candidate discoverability defaults to APPLIED_JOBS_ONLY; broader talent-pool visibility is separately consented.

- Payment-provider state is external evidence; IndiaWorks maintains its own canonical subscription state and reconciles webhooks idempotently.

9. Success Metrics

Metric family	Examples
Acquisition	Employer signup-to-trial, candidate OTP completion, recruiter activation.
Monetisation	Trial-to-paid conversion, monthly/annual mix, ARPA, add-on revenue, renewal/churn.
Hiring	Time to first qualified candidate, time to first contact, time to fill, application-to-shortlist, shortlist-to-hire.
Marketplace quality	Eligible match rate, candidate response/contact rate, job freshness, duplicate/fraud rate.
Promotion	Promoted-job impressions, qualified views, applications, contacts and incremental lift vs baseline.
Candidate experience	Job view-to-apply, application completion, alert engagement, withdrawal rate.

10. Scope and Release Boundaries

MVP	Later / optional
OTP auth; organisations/RBAC; trial/monthly/yearly plans; entitlements; structured jobs; candidate feed/search; applications; employer talent search; masked cards; contact reveal; promotion credits; payment webhooks; basic admin/audit.	Advanced ATS integrations; bulk API; AI-generated job descriptions; automated verification partners; ML learning-to-rank; payroll; background checks; interview video; referral marketplace.

11. Risks and Controls

Risk	Control
Subscription logic scattered across resolvers	Central EntitlementService; GraphQL resolvers call it rather than implementing plan rules.
Paid promotion harms relevance	Apply eligibility/relevance first; bounded promotion boost second; log ranking reason.
Candidate PII scraping	Mask by default; entitlement-gated reveal; rate limits; audit; export controls.
Taxonomy fragmentation	Versioned canonical taxonomy + aliases; no UI-label-as-schema shortcuts.
Candidate onboarding abandonment	Progressive capture; just-in-time fields; resume optional.
Payment webhook duplication/out-of-order delivery	Webhook inbox + idempotency key + provider event timestamp/version reconciliation.

12. Reference Lineage

This BRD is derived from the two approved IndiaWorks source artifacts above. External regulatory and market references already captured by those artifacts remain applicable, including NCO/NIC/NSQF taxonomy sources, NCS jobseeker/employer flows, UIDAI offline identity-verification guidance and India DPDP privacy requirements. The unified document does not replace legal review for production launch.

v7 commercial gate - five free candidates

Rule: A verified organisation/legal entity receives five lifetime free DISTINCT candidate unlocks. The sixth distinct candidate requires a paid monthly/yearly/add-on CANDIDATE_UNLOCK entitlement.

Rule	v7 behavior
Masked discovery	Applicant/search result cards and candidate counts are visible in masked form without consuming an unlock.
Consumption key	Only first full-profile access of a distinct (OrganisationId, CandidateProfileId) consumes candidate access.
Scope	The five free candidates are shared by every recruiter, every job and every candidate-access surface in the organisation.
No reset	Free allowance never resets by month, billing period, new recruiter, new job, device, cancellation or re-sign-up.
Duplicate candidate	Re-opening the same candidate or finding the same candidate against another job does not consume again.
Privacy first	Consent/application context, discoverability and candidate-organisation block rules are evaluated before payment/entitlement.
Paid access	Paid plan/add-on entitlements can grant further CANDIDATE_UNLOCK units or unlimited access.
Contact	Candidate contact reveal remains separately consent checked, entitlement checked and audited.
Abuse control	Commercial identity fingerprint/risk controls prevent recreating organisations purely to regain five free candidates.

v6 product/technical gap review integrated into v7

Area	Business decision
Authentication	One UserAccount may be both candidate and employer. Sessions are persistent/revocable and users switch active persona.
Employer team	Organisation invitations, seat limits and RBAC are explicit lifecycle concepts.
Job lifecycle	Job status and moderation status are independent; only published+approved+unexpired jobs are discoverable.
Job details	Compensation, shift/timing, benefits, location, skills, credentials, contact windows and interview information are structured.
Filters	Role, location/radius, work mode/type, experience, education/course, pay, shift, freshness, urgency, language/skills/credentials/assets, benefits and trust/source are independent facets.

Alerts	Saved filter, alert schedule and delivery history/deduplication are separate entities.
Share	Stable public/deep links use public code/slug and attribution rather than only a share event.
Employer CRM	EmployerCandidateRelationship persists across jobs; Application remains candidate-to-job.
Trust & safety	Report/block/moderation flows are first-class business requirements.

Updated business acceptance scenarios

- Candidate can complete OTP and browse/filter jobs without completing a full profile or resume.
- Employer can post a structured job and see masked applicants/candidate search results.
- Organisation unlocks distinct candidates 1 through 5 free; the sixth returns a visible upgrade paywall when no paid entitlement exists.
- Two recruiters in the same organisation cannot each obtain a separate set of five free candidates.
- A candidate already unlocked through Job A is still unlocked when found through Job B and does not consume another unit.
- After payment, entitlement is activated by reconciled provider state and the protected candidate action can be retried successfully.
- Paid promotion never overrides hard eligibility, candidate privacy/block state or job moderation state.

Updated release dependency

S0 Foundation -> S1 Identity/Tenancy/Free Allowance -> S2 Billing/Entitlement/Paywall -> S3 Employer Job Authoring -> S4 Candidate Discovery/Application -> S5 Applicant CRM + Paywall -> S6 Paid Candidate Database -> S7 Alerts/Promotion -> S8 Trust/Admin/Analytics -> S9 Hardening/UAT/Launch.